

Save up on Space

You can reduce the size of the image by as much as 30-45 MB, even after compressing the image.

Delete these with eyes closed

Help Files: The Windows/Help directory is full of information that you never read, especially if you don't use the help files. Retain certain files, such as Office help files, but delete all others, including some .avi files that are installed as part of the default setup. You could also do away with the .cnt files and .gid files which are used as part of the Help, Find and Search mechanisms.

The Browser Cache: Set to a minimum of about 1 per cent of the hard disk.

The Windows/Media directory: Delete all or selectively, it's up to you.

Fonts, cursors and wallpapers: How many do you actually use?

Office templates: A serious waste of space, though some may be useful. You can always reinstall these.

Information files: .txt files can be found all over your hard drive. These include some useful pieces of information, especially the tips.txt file in the Windows folder. But once you've read them, you could either delete or archive them. This would also apply to the readme.txt or readme.1st files, which seem to be scattered all over the place.

Pay attention to these

Windows Executable files: There are a lot of .exe files in the Windows directory that you never use. So figure out what they do and delete the ones that you wouldn't need. Once again, you'll find these on the installation CD.

Windows\inf directory: This isn't for the faint hearted, but if you know what you're doing, you will find a lot of wasted space in this directory. Use Quick-View or Notepad to view these files.

1/2 page
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Restoring the image

Restoring the image, when required, is a very simple task.

Step 1: Start your PC with the PQDI boot-disk inserted in the floppy drive. The floppy disk will take you to the PQDI wizard screen. Here click on 'Restore Image' and press Next to display the 'Open Image File' window.

Step 2: Browse to the folder where you saved the image and click OK. If you had specified a password for the image file, you will be asked to enter it here and press OK.

Step 3: Press Next then OK to display the 'Ready to restore image file' window. You can click on the Advanced option button to instruct PQDI to check for errors and viruses before restoring the image. The time taken to complete the restoration process will depend on the size of the image and the speed of your computer. When the process is completed, a confirmation dialog box will appear on the screen; click on Yes to exit to MS-DOS.

Step 4: Take out the floppy and restart your PC. You'll find the PC sans all the errors that forced you to restore the image in the first place.

A clean slate

So with all that said, you need not live your life in fear of a crash anymore. And when your PC does crash, you can sit back and dream about cellophane flowers in yellow and green, towering over your head. We didn't say this: John Lennon did! 🍷